







THE OTHER SHERPAS

1. G20 Sherpa Amitabh Kant at a meeting in Manesar, Sept. 4

2. External affairs minister S. Jaishankar attending the Ganga Aarti with G20 delegates in Varanasi, Jun. 11

3. Power minister R.K. Singh addressing his G20 counterparts in Goa, Jul. 22

4. Nirmala Sitharaman at the finance ministers and central bank governors meeting in Bengaluru, Feb. 24

BECOMING THE CHAMPION OF THE GLOBAL SOUTH IS INDIA'S BIGGEST CONTRIBUTION TO THE DELHI G20. THIS INCLUDES GETTING IN THE AFRICAN UNION

On the critical issue of strengthening MDBs, Seth says the report of the expert group headed by eminent financial experts N.K. Singh and Lawrence Summers "helped enlarge the scope of the discourse in terms of the building blocks, including how the existing capital could be delivered better, how capital, both public and private, could be augmented and what operational and organisational changes would be needed to promote growth and domestic reform for emerging and developing countries". On climate financing, India pushed for a Global South perspective. Apart from focusing on private capital, it called for public resources to play a big role. Seth says, "It is not just about money but access to technology. And about domestic resource-generation, especially in countries that have a high debt burden." There was also an important policy formulation for financing future cities that would, among other things, be energy-efficient, given the rapid urbanisation that many developing countries are experiencing.

Right from the beginning of India's G20 presidency last November, PM Modi has personally monitored all deliberations and pushed for deliverables. Kant says that the Indian G20 team was told to list these separately under each of the themes of One Earth, One Family, One Future. So, under One Earth, issues such as climate finance and Lifestyle for Sustainable Development (LiFE principles) were pushed through. For One Family, among other things, was accelerating the progress of SDGs. And for One Future, DPI was one of the key deliverables. Modi had promised that the G20 under India's presidency would be a catalyst for a New Global Order. As Harsh Shringla, former foreign secretary and chief coordinator for G20, says, "India introduced the concept of working for the global common good, in line with the prime minister's call for a human-centric globalisation where nations collaborate to solve major issues." This G20 was a good beginning. ■